

KS3: WATER AND SANITATION THROUGH TIME

Why did it take so long to clean up Britain?

Name: _____

Class: _____

Progress & Assessment Tracker	Effort	Level	Teacher Comments
L1: How much progress did the Romans make in public health?			
L2: Why did public health decline during the Middle Ages?			
L3: To what extent did towns become filthier during the Early Modern period?			
L4: How did the Industrial Revolution lead to a public health crisis?			
L5: Why did it take the 'Great Stink' to finally clean up Britain's streets?			
Assessment: Assessment Option 1: Public Health Domino Flowchart			
Assessment: Assessment Option 2: Cholera Investigation			
Assessment: Assessment Option 3: Source Utility Analysis			
Final Unit Grade:			

L1: How much progress did the Romans make in public health?

(See Textbook Page 3)

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- ☐ Identify the key features of this topic.
- ☐ Explain the core concepts and historical context.
- ☐ Evaluate the overall significance.
- ☐ Analyze a primary source related to the lesson theme.

Source A : Roman communal latrines at Housesteads Fort (Hadrian's Wall)



What is this source showing? This is a well-preserved example of a Roman communal latrine block. Notice the stone seating with holes positioned over a deep channel where running water continuously flushed waste away. Below the seats is a shallower gutter that carried clean water, used by the Romans to wet a communal sponge-on-a-stick (xylospongium) for wiping.

Q1. How does this source demonstrate both the advancements and limitations of Roman public health?

Do Now Activity

Score: / 5

1. What is a primary source?

2. What is a secondary source?

3. What does 'chronological order' mean?

4. What century is the year 1854 in?

5. What is the difference between BC and AD (or BCE and CE)?

Vocabulary Check

Fill in the blanks using the vocabulary words below.

cesspit conduit latrine

The Romans built massive aqueducts that acted as a _____ for fresh water. For waste, they used a _____ or went to a communal _____ where water flushed the waste away.

Q2. Enquiry: According to Seneca, what does this source reveal about the social and commercial atmosphere inside a Roman bathhouse? [p. 3]

Q4. Identify how Iron Age communities managed their waste.

Q5. Describe the purpose of Roman conduits and aqueducts.

Q6. Based on what you have learned about Roman sanitation, why do you think a wealthy palace like Fishbourne would have its own private bathhouse and hypocaust system, while ordinary Romano-British people did not?

Q7. Explain how bathhouses and latrines improved public health in Roman towns.

Q8. Evaluate the impact of the Roman withdrawal on Britain's sanitation.

Pair & Share Activity

Prompt: Discuss with your partner: Why would the Romans spend so much money on public health?

Think: Spend 1 minute quietly considering the question and forming your own opinion.

Your Notes:

Writing Practice

Scaffolding & Hints:

- Mention aqueducts.
- Mention public baths.

Q9. Write a PEEL paragraph explaining how the Romans tried to keep their towns clean.

General Notes

[illegible]

☐ Emerging (1-2) ☐ Emerging+ (3) ☐ Expected (4-5) ☐ Expected+ (6-7) ☐ Greater Depth (8-9)

Teacher Comment:

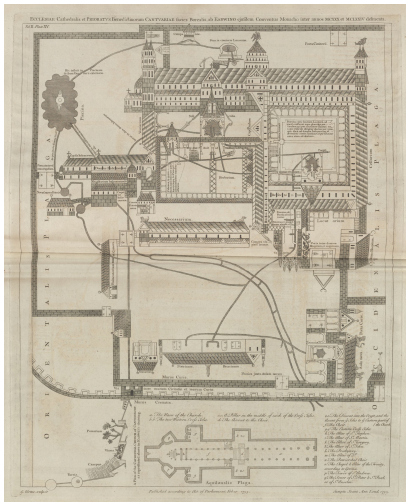
L2: Why did public health decline during the Middle Ages?

(See Textbook Page 6)

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- ☐ Identify the key features of this topic.
- ☐ Explain the core concepts and historical context.
- ☐ Evaluate the overall significance.
- ☐ Analyze a primary source related to the lesson theme.

Source A : The Canterbury Cathedral Waterworks Plan (c. 1165)



What is this source showing? This extraordinary map, drawn around 1165, shows the complex water system built for the monks of Christ Church Priory in Canterbury. It details pipes drawing fresh water from springs outside the city walls, directing it to a settling tank, and then routing it through the monastery to washbasins, the kitchen, and finally flushing the latrines.

Q1. What does this highly detailed plumbing plan suggest about the role of monasteries in preserving public health during the Medieval era?

Do Now Activity **Score: / 10**

1. What was the main feature of Iron Age Settlements & Cesspits?

2. How did Roman Conduits & Water Supply impact society?

3. Identify one major problem with The Roman Withdrawal.

4. Why were Iron Age cesspits safe?

5. How did the Romans move water?

6. What were Roman latrines?

7. What happened to sanitation when the Romans left?

8. Did Iron Age people pollute their water?

9. Why was flowing water important to Romans?

10. What is a conduit?

Vocabulary Check

Write a historically accurate sentence connecting two terms from the glossary box below.

gongfermer | miasma | monastery | cesspit | privy

Your Sentence:

Q3. Identify the main method of waste disposal in medieval villages like Wharram Percy.

Q4. Describe the sanitation facilities found in medieval monasteries like Canterbury Priory.

Q5. How does the water management system at Titchfield Abbey support the idea that monasteries were much healthier places to live than Medieval towns?

Q6. Explain why overcrowded medieval towns faced a filtration crisis.

Q7. Explain the role of gongfarmers in medieval towns.

Q8. Evaluate the significance of Edward III's cleanliness mandate in 1349.

Pair & Share Activity

Prompt: Discuss with your partner: Who had better public health, a Roman soldier or a Medieval monk?

Think: Spend 1 minute quietly considering the question and forming your own opinion.

Your Notes:

Writing Practice

Scaffolding & Hints:

- Mention the lack of sewers.
- Mention what people believed caused disease (miasma).

Q9. Write a PEEL paragraph explaining why public health in towns got worse during the Middle Ages.

General Notes

[illegible]

☐ Emerging (1-2) ☐ Emerging+ (3) ☐ Expected (4-5) ☐ Expected+ (6-7) ☐ Greater Depth (8-9)

Teacher Comment:

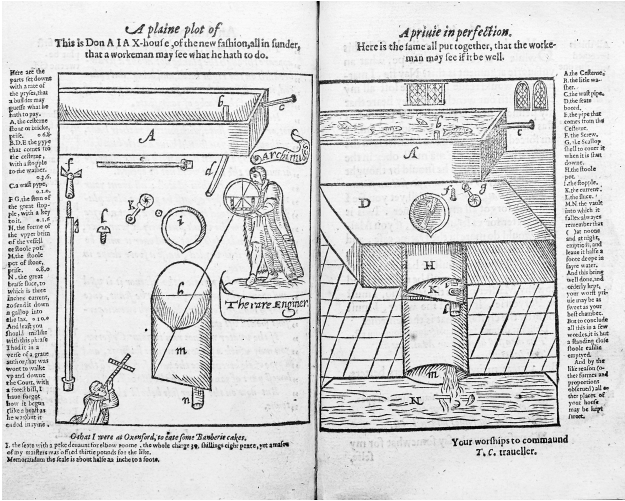
L3: To what extent did towns become filthier during the Early Modern period?

(See Textbook Page 8)

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- ☐ Identify the key features of this topic.
- ☐ Explain the core concepts and historical context.
- ☐ Evaluate the overall significance.
- ☐ Analyze a primary source related to the lesson theme.

Source A : Sir John Harington's flushing toilet design (1596)



What is this source showing? This diagram is from a 1596 pamphlet by Sir John Harington, a godson of Queen Elizabeth I. It illustrates his invention: the first modern flushing water closet, which he called the 'Ajax'. It featured a flush valve to release water and a wash-down design to empty the bowl.

Q1. Why do you think this brilliant invention failed to catch on in Early Modern Britain despite its obvious sanitary benefits?

Do Now Activity

1. What was the main feature of Peasant Cesspits?

2. How did Monastic luxury (Canterbury Priory) impact society?

Score: / 10

3. Identify one major problem with Gongfermers and night-work.

4. What was a Gongfermer?

5. Why did medieval monks build water systems?

6. What did Edward III order in 1357?

7. Why were medieval towns dangerous for health?

8. How did the Romans keep forts clean?

9. How did water sellers make money?

10. What is Miasma?

Vocabulary Check

Write a clear definition and a historically accurate sentence for the term: **conduit**

Q3. Identify who invented the first flushing water closet.

Q4. Describe the purpose of the New River project in 1613.

Q5. If you lived in the overcrowded, walled town of Tudor Portsmouth, what risks would you face from the lack of proper sewers and overflowing cesspits?

Q6. Explain what Samuel Pepys' diary reveals about Early Modern privies.

Q7. Evaluate the effectiveness of Early Modern water sellers for public health.

Pair & Share Activity

Prompt: Discuss with your partner: Why didn't Sir John Harington's flush toilet become popular instantly?

Think: Spend 1 minute quietly considering the question and forming your own opinion.

Your Notes:

Writing Practice

Scaffolding & Hints:

- Mention overcrowding.
- Mention the amount of waste produced.

Q8. Write a PEEL paragraph explaining why the growth of towns (urbanisation) made public health worse in the Early Modern period.

General Notes

[illegible]

☐ Emerging (1-2) ☐ Emerging+ (3) ☐ Expected (4-5) ☐ Expected+ (6-7) ☐ Greater Depth (8-9)

Teacher Comment:

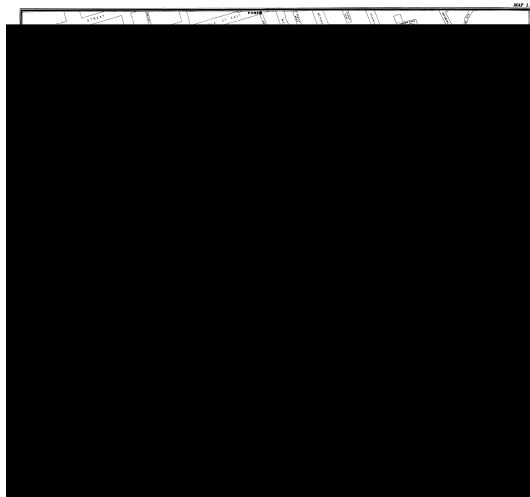
L4: How did the Industrial Revolution lead to a public health crisis?

(See Textbook Page 10)

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- ☐ Identify the key features of this topic.
- ☐ Explain the core concepts and historical context.
- ☐ Evaluate the overall significance.
- ☐ Analyze a primary source related to the lesson theme.

Source A : Dr. John Snow's Cholera Map of Soho (1854)



***What is this source showing?** This famous map was created by Dr. John Snow during the devastating 1854 cholera outbreak in Soho, London. Each black bar on the map represents a death from cholera at that specific address. Snow noticed that the deaths clustered tightly around one specific public water pump on Broad Street.*

Q1. How did Dr. Snow use this map to challenge the prevailing 'miasma' theory of disease?

Chronological Domino Flowchart

Score: / 5

Task: The historical events below are out of order. Read them carefully, then use your pen to **draw arrows connecting the boxes** in the correct chronological and causal order (Event A → Event B → Event C...).

1831

First Cholera Epidemic

Cholera arrives in Britain, killing thousands.

1780s

First Factories

Steam-powered textile mills begin mass production.

1800-1850

Rapid Urbanisation

Millions migrate to industrial towns looking for work.

1842

Chadwick's Report

Edwin Chadwick publishes his damning report on sanitary conditions.

1750

Rural Britain

Most of the population lives and works in the countryside.

1. Why do you think disease spread so quickly in the newly built industrial towns?

Vocabulary Check

Fill in the blanks using the vocabulary words below.

urbanization | cholera | epidemic | public health | laissez-faire

Rapid _____ meant cities grew too fast. The government believed in _____, doing nothing to help. This led to a terrible _____ of _____, forcing people to finally take _____ seriously.

Q3. Identify two effects of the industrial population surge on factory towns.

Q4. Describe the living conditions in industrial back-to-back housing.

Q5. Why did rapid population growth in places like Portsea make the 1849 cholera outbreak so devastating for the local community?

Q6. Explain how the cholera epidemics forced the government to act.

Q7. Evaluate the significance of Edwin Chadwick's 1842 report.

Pair & Share Activity

Prompt: Discuss with your partner: Was it fair for the government to follow a 'laissez-faire' attitude?

Think: Spend 1 minute quietly considering the question and forming your own opinion.

Your Notes:

Writing Practice

Scaffolding & Hints:

- Explain what people used to believe (miasma).
- Explain what Snow proved about water.

Q8. Write a PEEL paragraph explaining why John Snow's discovery at the Broad Street pump was a turning point.

General Notes

This image shows a single sheet of white paper with horizontal blue ruling lines. The lines are evenly spaced and run across the width of the page. There are no margins, text, or other markings on the paper.

☐ Emerging (1-2) ☐ Emerging+ (3) ☐ Expected (4-5) ☐ Expected+ (6-7) ☐ Greater Depth (8-9)

Teacher Comment:

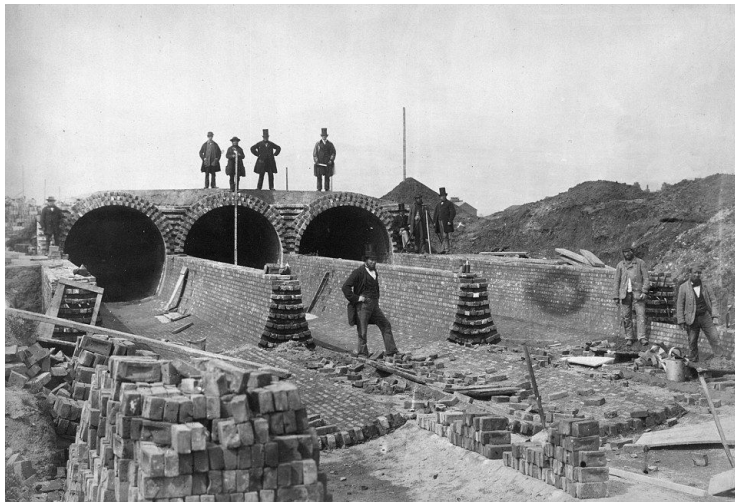
L5: Why did it take the 'Great Stink' to finally clean up Britain's streets?

(See Textbook Page 12)

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- ☐ Identify the key features of this topic.
- ☐ Explain the core concepts and historical context.
- ☐ Evaluate the overall significance.
- ☐ Analyze a primary source related to the lesson theme.

Source A : Construction of Joseph Bazalgette's intercepting sewers



***What is this source showing?** This photograph captures the colossal engineering effort required to build the London sewer system in the 1860s. Designed by Joseph Bazalgette, the project involved constructing 82 miles of massive enclosed brick intercepting sewers and 1,100 miles of street sewers to stop sewage from flowing directly into the River Thames.*

Q1. What does the sheer scale of this brickwork reveal about the Victorian government's response to the Great Stink of 1858?

Do Now Activity

Score: / 10

1. What was the main feature of Iron Age Settlements & Cesspits?

2. How did Roman Conduits & Water Supply impact society?

3. What was a Gongfermer?

4. Why did medieval monks build water systems?

5. What did Edward III order in 1357?

6. Why were medieval towns dangerous for health?

7. What terrifying waterborne disease first struck Britain in 1831?

8. What scientific theory did doctors wrongly believe caused disease before 1860?

9. Who published a damning report on sanitary conditions in 1842?

10. What was the 'laissez-faire' attitude?

Vocabulary Check

Write a historically accurate sentence connecting two terms from the glossary box below.

sewer germ theory sewage civil engineering infrastructure

Your Sentence:

Q3. Identify what John Snow's Broad Street map proved about cholera.

Q4. Describe the impact of the Great Stink on Parliament in 1858.

Q5. How did the construction of the Eastney Beam Engine House in 1887 solve the exact same public health crisis in Portsmouth that Bazalgette solved in London?

Q6. Explain how Joseph Bazalgette's sewer system solved London's waste problem.

Q7. Explain the link between Louis Pasteur's Germ Theory and sanitation.

Q8. Evaluate the significance of the 1875 Public Health Act for modern sanitation.

Pair & Share Activity

Prompt: Discuss with your partner: What finally forced Parliament to act?

Think: Spend 1 minute quietly considering the question and forming your own opinion.

Your Notes:

Writing Practice

Scaffolding & Hints:

- Mention the removal of sewage.
- Mention the end of cholera epidemics.

Q9. Write a PEEL paragraph explaining how Joseph Bazalgette's sewers improved public health in London.

General Notes

[illegible]

☐ Emerging (1-2) ☐ Emerging+ (3) ☐ Expected (4-5) ☐ Expected+ (6-7) ☐ Greater Depth (8-9)

Teacher Comment:
